

Safe Campus Toolkit

Practical guidance for students and university teams

A safer campus starts with clear support

Everyone deserves to study, work and socialise without harassment, intimidation or abuse. Safety is a shared responsibility. Responsibility for harmful behaviour always lies with the person causing it.

Use this toolkit

Students: start with the help routes on page 2, then use the checklists and contact planner. University teams: use the response guide on page 6 and the rollout plan in the companion pack.

Inside

- 02 Get help now
- 03 Everyday campus safety
- 04 Harassment, consent and sexual violence
- 05 Wellbeing and digital safety
- 06 Responding to a disclosure
- 07 Your campus contact planner
- 08 Sources and sharing

About this edition

UK-focused guidance, with NHS pathways on page 2 specifically labelled for England. Local services and university procedures vary. This toolkit supports awareness and planning; use qualified services for individual medical, safeguarding or legal decisions.

Share with care

The general toolkit can be shared as supplied. Complete and verify local contacts before presenting it as your university's guide. Keep completed personal worksheets private.

Get help now

Save this page somewhere you can find it quickly

Immediate danger or serious injury: 999

Call 999 for an emergency. Give your location and follow the operator's instructions. Contact campus security when safe, but do not delay emergency help. [4, 5]

Unable to speak on a mobile 999 call

Listen to the operator. If prompted, press 55 to be connected to police. A silent call does not automatically send help; provide your location if you can. This instruction applies to mobile calls. [4]

Urgent mental health help

In England, call NHS 111 and select the mental health option. If someone's life is at risk or you cannot keep yourself or someone else safe, call 999 or go to A&E. Elsewhere in the UK, use your local NHS or HSC urgent mental health route. [1]

Someone to talk to: 116 123

Samaritans is free to call, day or night. You can call when you are struggling or need someone to listen. It does not replace emergency services. [2]

Sexual assault support

A sexual assault referral centre (SARC) can offer specialist medical and practical support. You can seek support without first reporting to police. Use the NHS source on page 8 to find help; local arrangements and safeguarding limits may apply. [3]

Police and campus concerns

For non-emergency police matters, call 101 or use the relevant police online reporting route. For university concerns, contact your wellbeing team, safeguarding service or reporting service. [5]

Everyday campus safety

Small preparations that make support easier to reach

Before you go

Save campus security and wellbeing contacts. Know building exits and accessible routes. Plan travel home and a backup option. Agree a check-in with someone you trust if useful; sharing your location is your choice.

Travel, accommodation and late study

Choose routes and spaces that feel safe and accessible to you. Use available university transport or escorts. Keep entry codes private and report broken locks, lighting or access barriers. If you feel followed, go to a staffed place and ask for help.

Social events

Respect boundaries. Agree how friends will find each other and get home. If someone becomes unexpectedly unwell or you suspect spiking, seek urgent help, tell venue staff and stay with them if safe. Call 999 for an emergency; do not leave them to travel alone.

When you see concerning behaviour

Assess your safety first. You can ask staff for help, create a distraction or check in with the person afterwards. Do not confront someone if that could increase the danger. If there is immediate danger, call 999.

Team checklist

Check lighting, transport information, accessible help points and out-of-hours support. Include commuters, postgraduate researchers, disabled students, international students and students living away from halls. Invite feedback without asking people to disclose personal harm.

Respect, consent and reporting

Support should be available before someone decides to report

Consent and boundaries

Sexual activity needs freely given agreement. Agreement to one activity is not agreement to another, and consent can be withdrawn. Do not assume consent because of a relationship, silence or previous activity. If someone cannot choose freely or communicate agreement, stop.

Recognise a concern

Unwanted sexual attention, threats, coercion, repeated unwanted contact, discriminatory abuse and misuse of power can all be reasons to seek advice. Online behaviour matters too. You do not need to decide which legal label fits before asking for support.

If something happened to you

Get to a safer place if you can. You can ask a trusted person to stay with you. For sexual assault, contact a SARC promptly for advice about care and time-sensitive options. Seek help even if you have washed, changed clothes or are unsure about reporting. [3]

Your options

Ask about confidential advice, university reporting, police reporting and practical adjustments such as accommodation or teaching changes. Ask who will see information and what happens next. Anonymous routes may limit the action a university can take. Support and formal reporting are different processes.

Keep records only if safe

You may note dates, locations and what happened, or keep relevant messages securely. Avoid forwarding sensitive material widely or using shared group chats. You can seek help without having a complete record.

For university teams in England

OfS condition E6 came into force on 1 August 2025 for registered providers. Review the official requirements, including published information, support, reporting and training. This toolkit is not a compliance assessment. [8]

Wellbeing and digital safety

Support your health, relationships and online life

Notice when you need support

Persistent distress, isolation or difficulties managing daily life are reasons to reach out. You do not have to wait for a crisis. Contact student wellbeing, a GP or a trusted support service. Use page 2 when help is urgent.

Support a friend

Listen without judgment. Ask what would help and offer to contact support together. Do not promise secrecy if someone may be in immediate danger. If you cannot keep them safe, use emergency help. You can also ask for support for yourself.

Protect your accounts

Use a unique password for each account, ideally managed with a password manager. Enable two-step verification, especially for email. Keep devices updated and locked. Do not share login codes or approve unexpected sign-in requests. [7]

Pause before paying or clicking

Unexpected messages about fees, accommodation, jobs or account suspension can be scams. Verify requests through a known official website or contact, rather than the message's link or phone number. Report suspicious university messages to IT. [6]

Online harassment and intimate images

If safe, keep relevant messages and account details before blocking or reporting. Use platform reporting tools and university support. Never redistribute intimate images. If a device or account may be monitored, use a safer device to seek advice before changing settings.

Make support accessible

Ask for an interpreter, accessible format, communication adjustment or a support person if needed. University teams should publish how students can request these adjustments and what out-of-hours options exist.

Responding to a disclosure

A first-response guide for staff and student leaders

1. Listen and check immediate safety

Find a private, accessible space. Say: "Thank you for telling me. You deserve support." Ask whether urgent medical or emergency help is needed. Do not investigate, test the account or ask why the person did not act differently.

2. Explain your role and privacy limits

Before taking details, explain what you can do, what you must share and with whom. Do not promise absolute confidentiality. Follow your institution's safeguarding process, including any child or adult safeguarding duties. If unsure, seek designated advice with minimal identifying information where possible.

3. Offer choices and practical help

Ask what they need now. Explain support and reporting options without pressure. Offer a warm referral with permission: help make the call or connect them to the right team. Do not contact an alleged perpetrator or attempt mediation yourself.

4. Record only what is necessary

Use the approved secure system. Separate the person's words from your observations. Record agreed actions, consent and any required escalation. Restrict access; follow retention policies. Do not put sensitive details into personal email, public AI tools or student group chats.

5. Agree the next contact

Confirm who will follow up, how and when it is safe to contact the person. Explain what will happen if risk increases. Follow through on agreed actions and seek supervision for your own wellbeing.

Practice prompt

A student says: "Something happened at a society event, but I do not want to report it." Practise explaining support options, privacy limits and immediate safety checks while respecting their choice. Use fictional examples in training.

Your campus contact planner

A private worksheet: complete it using verified university information

Emergency reminder

UK emergency: 999 | Non-emergency police: 101 | Samaritans: 116 123

England urgent mental health: NHS 111, mental health option. [1, 2, 5]

University contacts

University / campus: _____

Security number and hours: _____

Wellbeing contact and hours: _____

Safeguarding contact: _____

Reporting page / office: _____

Out-of-hours support: _____

Independent and practical support

Students' union advice: _____

Local sexual assault support / SARC: _____

Local urgent mental health route: _____

Accessibility / disability support: _____

Accommodation / emergency transport: _____

My choices

A trusted person I can contact: _____

A safer place I can go: _____

My backup journey home: _____

Safe way and time to contact me: _____

Before you use or share this sheet

Check numbers, links, hours and eligibility. Record the date checked: _____

A completed sheet can contain sensitive information. Store it privately. Share only the details needed to obtain support; use a blank copy for wider distribution.

Sources and sharing

Source information checked on 7 October 2026

Official support and guidance

[1] NHS: urgent mental health support

<https://www.nhs.uk/nhs-services/mental-health-services/where-to-get-urgent-help-for-mental-health/>

[2] Samaritans: contact and 116 123

<https://www.samaritans.org/how-we-can-help/contact-samaritan/>

[3] NHS: help after rape and sexual assault

<https://www.nhs.uk/live-well/sexual-health/help-after-rape-and-sexual-assault/>

[4] Police.uk: silent 999 calls

<https://www.police.uk/pu/contact-us/how-to-make-a-silent-999-call/>

[5] Police.uk: reporting routes

<https://www.police.uk/pu/contact-us/what-and-how-to-report/how-to-report>

[6] NCSC: spotting scams

<https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/collection/phishing-scams/spot-scams>

[7] NCSC: two-step verification

<https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/pdfs/guidance/setting-two-factor-authentication-2fa.pdf>

[8] Office for Students: condition E6

<https://www.officeforstudents.org.uk/for-providers/student-protection-and-choice/harassment-and-sexual-misconduct/condition-e6-harassment-and-sexual-misconduct/>

Use and adaptation

Q Intelligence grants permission to share and print this pack for educational and campus awareness purposes. Keep the source list and edition date. Adaptations should identify their editor and revision date. No affiliation or endorsement by the listed organisations is implied.

Local review

University teams should verify local routes and obtain appropriate safeguarding and accessibility review before adopting an adapted edition. Review links and contacts each term and after service changes. E6 is an England-specific regulatory reference. NHS pathways vary across UK nations.